

Create and Submit One Multipage PDF

A student guide for turning photos or scans of handwritten notes into one readable PDF file

Your goal: Submit one PDF containing every page, in the correct order—not a group of separate photos or separate PDF files.

Choose the method that fits your device

Method	What you need	Why choose it
Adobe Scan	iPhone, iPad, or Android phone/tablet	Free app; easiest cross-platform choice
Apple Notes	iPhone or iPad	Built in; no additional app needed
Google Drive scan	Android phone/tablet	Built into the Google Drive app
Google Docs	Chromebook, laptop, or desktop	Use photos already saved on the computer or in Drive
Microsoft Word	Windows or Mac computer	Use photos, then export or print to PDF
Printer/library scanner	No smartphone required	Scan several pages directly into one PDF

Before you begin

- Place each page on a flat surface with bright, even lighting.
- Hold the camera directly above the page; avoid shadows, glare, fingers, and cropped edges.
- Photograph pages in order, or reorder them before saving.
- If using a computer, transfer the photos by email, USB cable, AirDrop, cloud storage, or another method available to you.

Privacy reminder: Before using a scanning or cloud-storage app, remove unrelated personal information from the camera view and follow your course or institution's data-handling requirements.

Option 1: Adobe Scan

Best for: students using an iPhone, iPad, or Android device who want one consistent app.

Create the PDF

1. Install the free Adobe Scan app from your device's app store, then open it. Sign in if the app asks you to.
2. Choose Document mode. Position the first page inside the camera frame.
3. Let the app capture the page automatically, or tap the capture button.
4. Continue scanning until all pages are included in the same scan session.
5. Tap the page preview. Crop or rotate pages as needed, delete mistakes, and drag pages into the correct order.
6. Tap Save PDF. Rename the file using your instructor's requested naming format.
7. Use Share, Save a copy, or Open in... to place the PDF in Files, Google Drive, OneDrive, or another location you can access for submission.

Important: Do not finish and save after every page. Keep scanning within the same session so Adobe Scan creates one multipage PDF.

Submit

8. Open the assignment in Canvas or the submission system named by your instructor.
9. Choose File Upload, locate the saved PDF, and attach it.
10. Wait for the upload to finish, then submit. Reopen the submitted file if possible and confirm every page is present.

Option 2: Scan with Apple Notes

Best for: students using an iPhone or iPad who do not want to install another app.

Create the PDF

1. Open the Notes app and create a new note.
2. Tap the attachment or camera icon, then choose Scan Documents. Depending on your iOS/iPadOS version, Scan Documents may appear under the paperclip menu.
3. Position the first page in view. The device may capture automatically; otherwise, tap the shutter button.
4. Adjust the corners if needed, then choose Keep Scan. Continue scanning the remaining pages.
5. Tap Save only after all pages have been captured. The pages will be stored together as one scanned document in the note.
6. Tap the scanned document, then tap Share. Choose Save to Files and select a location.
7. Give the PDF a clear filename and save it.

If the menu looks different: Apple changes icon locations between versions. Look for Scan Documents under the attachment, paperclip, camera, or More (...) menu.

Submit

8. In the assignment, choose File Upload or Browse.
9. Select the PDF from Files, wait for it to upload, and submit.
10. Confirm that the submission shows one PDF and that every page is readable.

Option 3: Scan with Google Drive

Best for: students using an Android phone or tablet. The exact buttons may vary by device and Drive version.

Create the PDF

1. Open the Google Drive app and sign in to the account you use for coursework.
2. Tap New (+), then choose Scan or Scan document. On some versions, a camera/scan button appears near the bottom of the screen.
3. Photograph the first page and confirm that it is clear and fully inside the crop boundary.
4. Tap Add page (+) to capture the next page. Repeat until every page is included.
5. Use the editing controls to crop, rotate, retake, or reorder pages if those controls are available.
6. Tap Done or Save. Choose PDF if asked, enter a clear filename, select a Drive folder, and save.

Important: Use Add page before saving. Starting a new scan for each page creates separate files.

Submit

7. Open the assignment and choose File Upload or the Google Drive option if your course provides one.
8. Select the PDF. If selecting from Drive is unavailable, download the PDF to the device first and upload the downloaded copy.
9. Submit and verify that the complete PDF opens correctly.

Option 4: Put photos into Google Docs

Best for: students using a Chromebook, laptop, desktop, borrowed computer, or campus computer. No smartphone is required once the image files are available.

What you need: One image file for each page. Images may come from a digital camera, webcam, tablet, borrowed phone, email attachment, USB drive, or files already uploaded to Google Drive.

Build the document

1. On a computer, go to Google Docs and create a Blank document.
2. Rename the document using the filename requested by your instructor.
3. Choose File → Page setup. Use Portrait orientation and standard margins unless your instructor specifies otherwise.
4. Choose Insert → Image, then select Upload from computer or Drive. Insert the first page photo.
5. Click the image and choose In line with text. Resize it using a corner handle so the entire page fits without distortion.
6. Place the cursor after the image and choose Insert → Break → Page break. This keeps each photographed note page on its own PDF page.
7. Insert the next image. Repeat the image-and-page-break process until all pages are included in order.
8. Review every page. Rotate images before inserting them if needed, and delete blank pages or accidental duplicates.

Download as one PDF

9. Choose File → Download → PDF Document (.pdf). The browser will save one PDF containing all pages.
10. Open the downloaded PDF and confirm the page order, readability, and page count.
11. Upload that PDF—not the Google Docs editing link—to the assignment.

Avoid stretched images: Resize from a corner, not a side handle. If an image spills onto a second page, make it slightly smaller.

Option 5: Put photos into Microsoft Word

Best for: students with access to Word on a Windows or Mac computer, including many campus computers.

Build the document

1. Open Word and create a blank document.
2. Choose Insert → Pictures and add the first page photo from the computer.
3. Set the picture layout to In Line with Text. Resize from a corner so the full image fits on one page.
4. Place the cursor after the picture and insert a page break: Insert → Page Break, or press Ctrl+Enter on Windows / Command+Enter on Mac.
5. Insert each remaining photo in order, placing one note page on each document page.
6. Review the document for sideways pages, duplicates, missing edges, and blank pages.

Save as one PDF

7. Windows: choose File → Save As or Export, then select PDF as the file type.
8. Mac: choose File → Save As and select PDF, or choose File → Print → PDF → Save as PDF.
9. Open the PDF, check it, and upload the PDF file to the assignment.

Option 6: Use a printer, copier, or library scanner

Best for: students without a smartphone or students who prefer not to use a phone.

Where to look

- A campus computer lab, library, department office, accessibility office, or student support center
- A home or workplace multifunction printer/copier
- A public library or copy/print shop

Scan all pages into one PDF

1. Place loose pages in the automatic document feeder in the correct order, or place the first page on the scanner glass.
2. Choose Scan and select PDF—not JPG or PNG—as the output format.
3. Select Multiple pages, Combine into one document, or Add pages if the scanner provides that choice.
4. Scan the first page. If using the glass, choose Add page or Scan more pages and replace the page on the glass. Repeat until finished.
5. Choose Finish or Save only after the final page.
6. Save the PDF to a USB drive, your OSU OneDrive, Google Drive, email, or another permitted location. Do not leave your file saved on a public computer.
7. Open the saved file and check every page before submitting it.

Ask for help: If you cannot find a multipage setting, ask library or computer-lab staff to help you scan the pages as one PDF. Tell them you need a single multipage PDF, not separate image files.

Final submission checklist

Complete this check regardless of which method you used.

- ☐ The file is a PDF (.pdf), not a set of JPG/PNG photos or a document-sharing link.
- ☐ There is only one uploaded file.
- ☐ Every required page is included.
- ☐ Pages are in the correct order and oriented upright.
- ☐ Writing is readable when the PDF is opened at normal size.
- ☐ No page edges or important notes are cut off.
- ☐ There are no duplicate, blank, or unrelated pages.
- ☐ The filename follows the instructor's directions.
- ☐ The upload finished, and the assignment shows a successful submission.

If your PDF is too large

- Retake photos with good light so the app does not need to preserve excessive visual noise.
- Use a scanning app's default or medium-quality setting rather than the highest photo-quality setting.
- In Google Docs or Word, reduce oversized images before exporting—but keep handwriting readable.
- If the course allows it, use a reputable PDF compression tool approved by your institution. Check the compressed file before submitting.

If you cannot complete any method

Contact your instructor before the deadline. Explain what device or access barrier you have and ask about campus scanning support or an approved alternate submission method. Do not wait until after the assignment closes.